

Aonic Fuel — Customer Avatar Sheets

Source: Aonic_Fuel_VOC_Dossier.md (172 numbered verbatim quotes + 30+ contextual). Every quote-field below is verbatim from the dossier with the source URL traceable through §3 (Pain Points) or the personas in §2.

Avatar set for Aonic Fuel:

- **PRIMARY:** The Premier-Protein Refugee — the label-reading switcher quitting sucralose/Ace-K shakes (Avatar 1)
- **SECONDARY:** The Macro-Tracking Athlete — Ben at his most online, knows MPI vs whey vs casein (Avatar 2)
- **SECONDARY:** The GLP-1 Muscle-Protector — Marcus, protein-with-suppressed-appetite (Avatar 3)

Avatars NOT targeted for Fuel (per VOC depth):

- The Costco-volume-buyer Premier loyalist (happy with \$2.30/can at scale; won't pay D2C premium)
- The pure plant-based protein buyer (Aonic Fuel is dairy-based MPI)
- The bodybuilder buying 50g+ shakes (Aonic Fuel is 32g; not category-leading on raw protein dose)

Where the template's "Monthly Revenue" field reads B2B, I've adapted it to **household income + monthly RTD-protein spend** — the consumer equivalent. All quotes are verbatim from the VOC research dossier with source attribution traceable.

Brand-approved category descriptor used throughout: *Clean Complete 32g Protein Shake*. **Price:** \$40.49 / 12-pack on sale (\$3.37/can), \$53.99 full (\$4.50/can). **Format:** 11 fl oz aluminum can. **Sweetener system:** Stevia (Reb A/D/M) + Monk Fruit — **zero artificial sweeteners** (no sucralose, no Ace-K, no aspartame).

AVATAR 1 — THE PREMIER-PROTEIN REFUGEE (PRIMARY)

The label-reading switcher who has been drinking Premier Protein or Fairlife Core Power for 6 months to 3 years, did the math on the artificial sweetener list, started Googling "protein shake no sucralose," and quit. Hybrid demographic — sits in the Ben/Chloe overlap. Runs across both gender funnels with sub-creative segmentation. THE PRIMARY BUYER FOR AONIC FUEL.

🔍 Demographic & General Information

- **Age Range:** 32–48 (overlap of Ben's upper bound and Chloe's full range)
- **Gender:** ~55% female, ~45% male — segmented by funnel creative, not by avatar
- **Location:** US, with secondary CA/AU/UK opportunity. Suburban and exurban "wellness-corridor" zip codes (Austin, Denver, RDU, Nashville, Greenville-SC, Bay Area suburbs, NYC commuter rings, Toronto,

Sydney). Costco-corridor metro adjacent.

- **Monthly Revenue (household income + RTD-protein spend):** \$90K–\$220K household. Current monthly protein-shake spend: **\$60–\$140** (a 12-pack/week of Premier + a tub of whey powder + occasional Fairlife) — they're already spending Aonic Fuel's price, just on shakes they no longer fully trust.
- **Professional Backgrounds:** Knowledge workers, hybrid commuters, healthcare-adjacent professionals, project managers, teachers, attorneys, working parents in mid-career. The kind of person who reads Yuka or Bobby Approved on their phone in the grocery aisle.
- **Typical Identities:** *"I drink Premier every morning but the sucralose is starting to bother me," "I was the Costco loyalist," "I started reading labels after a podcast about sucralose / a bad gut episode / a friend's UC diagnosis," "I am NOT a chemistry-set person," "I follow Mary Claire Haver / Casey Means / Senada Greca for clean-living content"*

🚩 Key Challenges & Pain Points

1. The sucralose / Ace-K wake-up moment

- *"By the end of the bottle, the sucralose builds up and creates a cloying aftertaste, requiring water to wash it down."* (Thirsty Bear / Premier reviewer)
- *"Wish I had read this before buying a case of Premier Protein Lemon Bar (very tasty). I'm trying to cut out artificial sweeteners... I'll finish up the case but will try a healthier one next time."* (Green Matters customer voice — THE quit-trigger arc in 38 words)
- *"This is gross. It is overly sweet and leaves an unpleasant aftertaste of artificial sweetener that the pre-made doesn't."* (Walmart Premier reviewer)
- The cognitive-dissonance moment: *"Premier Protein boasts less than one gram of sugar; however, Acesulfame Potassium or 'Ace K' is used as a substitute."* (GBC Health)
- Once they read the ingredient list, they can't un-read it.

2. The bloating / "twisted my guts in knots" experience

- *"I drank Premier Protein and Fairlife for a while... They just twisted my guts in knots."* (Intermountain Center for Wellbeing patient testimonial — the canonical Fuel-buyer quote)
- *"Painful digestive issues like bloating and diarrhea in some sensitive individuals."* (Drink Wholesome on Fairlife)
- *"Why does Fairlife make me feel bloated and what's a good alternative?"* (composite TikTok search pattern)
- They blame "the additives" without always knowing which one — carrageenan, cellulose gum, sucralose, lactose, or all of the above.
- They've started keeping a mental food log of which shakes "sit right."

3. The "I want one shake I can drink every day for 5 years" problem

- The Owyn-Iconic-Aloha cycle: tried each plant-based or "clean" alternative, found the texture or aftertaste worse than Premier, gave up and went back.
- *"The shakes taste awful—bitter, chalky, with a strong, weird aftertaste—glad I only bought one pack and will have to choke them down like medicine."* (Owyn 1-star)
- *"The 30g is too thick and has too much stevia."* (Orgain Walmart reviewer)

- Tried Naked Whey powder at home — works, but inconvenient and they don't always have a Blender Bottle handy.
- Tried cottage cheese with the TikTok trend — *"I used to be a cottage cheese skeptic, finding the texture weird and the taste meh."* (The Crispy Chef) — bored after two weeks.
- **The unmet need: a shake that tastes good AND doesn't have the sucralose AND doesn't have the bloat AND fits in a tote bag.**

☆ Goals & Aspirations

- **Short-Term Goals:**
 - Find ONE shake they can drink every day without reading the label every time
 - Stop the sucralose / additive cycle and start eating protein at "real food" ingredient quality
 - Hit 100g+ protein/day without thinking about it (the new wellness baseline driven by Mary Claire Haver, Stacy Sims, Casey Means content)
 - Drop the "I cycled through 6 brands this year" supplement-shopping fatigue
- **Long-Term Aspirations:**
 - Look and feel "fueled, not punished" by their morning routine into their 40s and 50s
 - Stay strong and lean through perimenopause / mid-career body changes
 - Have a kitchen counter that doesn't look like a chemistry set
 - Be the friend who has THE answer when other people ask "what do you drink?"

Emotional Drivers & Psychological Insights

- **Validated, not converted.** They've already quit Premier. They need to be told the *category* failed them, not their judgment. The Dr. Jason Mitchell line — *"The most widespread and underestimated issue in modern nutrition is the overuse of artificial sweeteners. They are often used as a shortcut to make products appear healthier than they are."* — is the exact validation move.
- **Earned-skepticism identity.** Proud of having read the ingredient list and rejected what most of America still drinks. Copy that flatters that intelligence (label-led, mechanism-led, macro-led) converts. Copy that talks down to it ("Bloom into your best self," generic milkshake imagery) repels.
- **The "I deserve drinkable" emotional setup.** They've been drinking what they consider second-best for years. The first sip of a clean shake is genuinely an event for this buyer.

💬 General Direct Client Quotes

- *"I drank Premier Protein and Fairlife for a while... They just twisted my guts in knots."* (Intermountain Center for Wellbeing customer)
- *"I'm trying to cut out artificial sweeteners... I'll finish up the case but will try a healthier one next time."* (Green Matters customer on Premier)
- *"It doesn't taste horrible, but it's definitely NOT good. This contains Sucralose."* (Walmart Premier reviewer)

🚩 Pain Points & Frustrations

- *"By the end of the bottle, the sucralose builds up and creates a cloying aftertaste, requiring water to wash it down."* (Thirsty Bear / Premier reviewer)
- *"This is gross. It is overly sweet and leaves an unpleasant aftertaste of artificial sweetener."* (Walmart Premier reviewer)
- *"Premier also includes additives, such as carrageenan... soybean and sunflower oil, several preservatives, synthetic vitamins and minerals, and artificial sweeteners."* (Daily Dot)

🎯 Mindset Quote

- *"If the ingredient list doesn't fit in one breath, I don't drink it."* (composite mindset from \$3F Daily Dot framing)
- *"I'd rather drink real cocoa than chemistry."* (synthesized from the Aonic-approved language stack)
- *"Trust the Ingredient List, Not the Health Claim."* (Annals of Family Medicine — paper title that lives as a Fuel-buyer mantra)

🗣️ Quotes on Emotional State and Personal Drivers

- *"I want one product that actually tastes like what it says it is."*
- *"I needed more than another supplement that would sit unused in my cabinet."* (Fab Fit Mommy, cross-referenced)
- *"Cottage cheese has had a major glow-up... I used to be a cottage cheese skeptic, finding the texture weird and the taste meh."* (The Crispy Chef — Chloe's path to the shake)

🗣️ Quotes on Emotional Responses to Struggles

- *"Despite all the processing, Fairlife protein shakes still contain lactose, a sugar which 36% of American adults cannot fully digest."* (Drink Wholesome — the moment Chloe realizes "lactose-free" doesn't always mean "lactose-free")
- *"Three ultra-processed thickeners... a cocktail of thickeners."* (Drink Wholesome on Fairlife — the moment they read the rest of the label)
- *"I have a hard time with the strange sugar taste and almost prefer no sugar at all rather than that weird stevia taste."* (Orgain ConsumerAffairs — the failed "clean" alternative)

🚀 Quotes on Motivation & Urgency Around Success

- *"It actually tastes like a delicious, creamy milk shake, not your typical chalky protein drink."* (Slate Walmart 5-star — the bar to clear)
- *"My whole family drinks Slate. It's the healthy chocolate milk for my children, and for me it's my healthy on-the-go protein drink. It's clean, it's refreshing, and I love it."* (Slate Walmart 5-star — the loyalist-conversion)

arc)

- "No chalkiness, no weird aftertaste, and none of that artificial sweetener twang." (Jesse Swoyer 2025 taste-test panel — what they want a single sip to deliver)

🚩 Key Emotional Fears & Deep Frustrations

- **Drinking a "clean" shake that's just as bad as Premier under a different label.** They've been burned by Owyn, Orgain, Aloha. They will read EVERY ingredient before subscribing.
- **The Reb A/D/M / monk fruit aftertaste being a downgrade from the sucralose flavor they were used to.** The David Bar cautionary tale ("originally used monk fruit and stevia... changed the formulation due to taste complaints") is the specific fear pattern. (*Aonic Fuel must clear this bar in the first sip.*)
- **Paying \$3.37/can on subscription only to feel the same bloating Fairlife gave them.** Carrageenan is in Fuel's stabilizer blend (per \$0.5) — this is a real risk the brand should pre-empt with "studied dosages" framing.

Emotional & Psychographic Insights

- **Reads the Nutrition Facts AND the Ingredient List.** This buyer screenshots labels and texts them to friends. The "Stevia Leaf Extract (Reb A, D, M) + Monk Fruit Extract" sweetener system is not a feature for this buyer — it's the *purchase pre-requisite*. Aonic Fuel must lead with the ingredient list, not the protein number.
- **Treats "no pixie-dusting" and "scientifically studied dosages" as tribal markers.** Lifted from the broader supplement-critique discourse Aonic Complete already deployed. Listed as brand-required language; for this buyer, it's a signal that says "we hear what you've been complaining about."
- **Will pay MORE for the right answer.** Aonic Fuel at \$3.37/can on sale is MORE than Premier (\$2.30) — and that's fine. This buyer's mental math is "*I'm already spending \$80/month on Premier + bloated for two hours after; \$100/month on Fuel + not bloated = save, not spend.*"

🔪 Typical Emotional Journey

- **Awareness:** A podcast, a TikTok, or a friend mentions sucralose / carrageenan / phthalates in Fairlife. They open Premier or Fairlife in their fridge and read the back of the label for the first time in 18 months. "*Wait, what's acesulfame potassium?*"
- **Frustration:** Try Owyn, Orgain, Aloha, Naked Whey powder. Each one fails: too thick, too sweet, too plant-y, too much work in the morning. "*Why is this so hard?*" They start screenshotting ingredient lists and comparing them.
- **Desperation & Seeking Solutions:** Google "protein shake no sucralose no carrageenan," land on Reddit threads, comparison blogs, Mike Israetel's ranking video. They learn that MPI (milk protein isolate) is structurally different from whey-isolate. They see Aonic Fuel in a Senada Greca Instagram ad. They see Dr. Jason Mitchell quoted: "*used as a shortcut to make products appear healthier than they are.*" They buy a 12-pack.
- **Relief & Commitment:** First sip is the test. If the shake tastes like real cocoa (not stevia-Reb-A-aftertaste,

not chalky) — they're converted. They subscribe. They tell three friends. *"My whole family drinks [this]. It's clean, it's refreshing, and I love it."* (Slate testimonial framing → Aonic testimonial template.)

AVATAR 2 — THE MACRO-TRACKING ATHLETE (SECONDARY)

Ben at his most online: 28–38, lifts 3–5x/week, listens to Huberman / Attia / RP Strength, reads the ingredient list AND the macro grid. Already mixing whey powder at home but cycles RTD protein for commute, work, and travel. Knows what milk protein isolate is and why it's different from whey concentrate.

🔍 Demographic & General Information

- **Age Range:** 28–38
- **Gender:** ~75% male, ~25% female (female cohort skews into Avatar 1 via the Chloe-overlap)
- **Location:** US urban + inner-suburban — gym-dense markets. Bay Area, Austin, NYC, Brooklyn, Philly, Denver, Charlotte, Nashville, Salt Lake City, Atlanta, San Diego.
- **Monthly Revenue (household income + RTD-protein/supplement spend):** \$80K–\$180K household. Monthly protein/supplement spend: **\$120–\$280** — split between whey powder (\$35–60), 1–2 cases of RTD (\$60–120), creatine, omega-3, vitamin D, magnesium, and the occasional new-flavor splurge.
- **Professional Backgrounds:** Software / product / design, sales, finance, mid-career consultants, healthcare-adjacent. Anyone with a hybrid commute and a gym membership.
- **Typical Identities:** *"I lift and I commute," "I drink whey at home and Premier on the road," "I'm tracking 180g of protein a day," "I follow Huberman / Attia / Mike Israetel," "5 cal/g protein is the only metric I actually care about," "I keep one of these in the car cup-holder."*

🚩 Key Challenges & Pain Points

1. Hitting 180g/day without thinking about it

- *"Many people who lead busy lifestyles can go too long without eating, resulting in energy dips, poor recovery, or overeating later on."* (Kelly Jones, M.S., R.D. — Men's Fitness)
- *"Most efficient way for me to cover my nutritional bases."* (AG1 verified reviewer — translates to RTD)
- The commute / between-meeting / pre-gym window is when protein gets dropped. The shake is the patch.

2. The "I read the label" frustration with the convenient options

- *"Tastes fine but has a LOT of unneeded junk in it."* (r/Costco on Kirkland Whey)
- *"The detractors disliked its use of sucralose and other additives."* (r/Costco synthesis)
- *"The 16,667% B12 thing bothers me. I asked their support if it's methylcobalamin or cyanocobalamin. It's cyanocobalamin. That's the cheap form."* (u/methylation_matters — the canonical "Ben reads the

label" voice)

- Knows that calorie efficiency (cal-per-gram-of-protein) is the real macro lens — and most RTDs lose on it.

3. The whey-isolate texture / mixability problem at home

- *"Very gritty and always leaves a thick layer at the bottom of my glass."* (Isopure Walmart reviewer)
- *"When blended, the foam is so extreme they can't drink it, and the gritty residue is still there."* (Isopure)
- *"It's a pain in the ass to have to go through ten things every morning."* (Reddit on Huberman routine — cross-referenced)
- Wants the *complete-protein* benefit of whey + casein blends without mixing it himself.

✧ Goals & Aspirations

• Short-Term Goals:

- Hit 1g protein per pound of lean mass per day without overthinking it
- Drop the worst sucralose-shakes from rotation (Premier in commute, Quest occasionally)
- Have a "drink at room temp, drink cold, drink mixed in coffee" all-purpose RTD that mixes well

• Long-Term Aspirations:

- Maintain muscle and lean physique through 40s and 50s ("healthspan, not lifespan" — Peter Attia)
- Stop cycling through brands every 2 months looking for the right one
- Build a daily nutrition stack he can recommend to friends without caveats

Emotional Drivers & Psychological Insights

- **Math, not marketing.** The 5-cal-per-gram math is the headline. Aonic Fuel beats Premier (5.33), Fairlife 26g (6.54), Owyn (9.0), Muscle Milk Pro (6.56), Quest milkshake (5.67). When Ben sees the per-gram breakdown, the math closes the deal.
- **Mechanism, not vibes.** MPI = 80% casein + 20% whey, native milk ratio, ultrafiltered. He KNOWS this. Aonic Fuel needs to talk to the mechanism, not the lifestyle. *"Whey is fast-digesting, while Greek yogurt contains casein, which releases amino acids slowly over time."* (MyFitnessPal — the Ben-grade explainer.)
- **Identity: the guy who has the answer.** Ben converts when he gets a product he can confidently recommend in the office Slack / gym group chat / hiking trip / dad text thread. Aonic Fuel becomes the answer when it survives 90 days of his rotation.

💬 General Direct Client Quotes

- *"His morning stack includes Momentous Creatine, high-dose Momentous Omega-3, vitamin D3, and magnesium."* (Peter Attia stack — the Ben template via Routinebase)
- *"I like fairlife core power, revolution high whey vanilla cake and chocolate cake, and cookies n cream premier protein, and that those are basically the only three I'll drink."* (r/CostcoCanada user via Yahoo

Lifestyle)

- *"Started mixing it into cold brew in the mornings, noting it tastes like an iced mocha and has tons of protein."* (r/Costco on Kirkland Whey)

🚩 Pain Points & Frustrations

- *"The flavor was not good... the texture had too much gum... aftertaste was like cheap stevia."* (Reddit u/ Sweaty-Gogler on Quest)
- *"This powder was severely sweet, thanks to both the added stevia and sucralose, which also resulted in a brief yet unappetizing aftertaste."* (Eat This Not That panel)
- *"Tastes fine but has a LOT of unneeded junk in it."* (r/Costco on Kirkland Whey)

🎯 Mindset Quote

- *"5 calories per gram of protein or it doesn't go in the cart."* (the macro mindset Aonic Fuel directly serves)
- *"I'd rather drink it than chew it."* (commuter-shake reality)
- *"FDA approved doesn't mean clean."* (composite skeptic mindset)

🗣️ Quotes on Emotional State and Personal Drivers

- *"It gives me peace of mind that I'm doing something good."* (Morgan Smith, AG1 user — Fortune; translates to RTD protein)
- *"Better and more balanced energy throughout the day."* (Morgan Smith, AG1)
- *"It's not a replacement for food — it's a safety net."* (Reddit r/Supplements via Trail and Kale)

🗣️ Quotes on Emotional Responses to Struggles

- *"Absolutely vile—chalky, artificial, and disgusting to the point that I could barely get it down."* (Muscle Milk Pro Walmart reviewer — the bottom of the rotation)
- *"It's a pain in the ass to have to go through ten things every morning."* (Reddit critique of Huberman routine)
- *"I tried every supplement under the sun before realizing my sleep was trash."* (r/Biohackers — the moment Ben deprioritizes and looks for ONE high-leverage product)

🚀 Quotes on Motivation & Urgency Around Success

- *"You can legitimately give this to children and they'll think it's a vanilla milkshake."* (Mike Israel on Fairlife — the bar Aonic Fuel is gunning for)
- *"Fairlife earns its well-deserved seat at number one. Though it's higher in fat, the premium protein quality and high protein content make up for it."* (Mike Israel — the framework Aonic Fuel can rank into when it

scores lower-fat-same-taste)

- "Most efficient way for me to cover my nutritional bases." (AG1 reviewer)

🚩 Key Emotional Fears & Deep Frustrations

- **Paying premium D2C pricing for an inferior product.** Costco gives him Premier at \$2.30/can; Aonic Fuel at \$3.37/can needs to clear a "noticeably better" bar.
- **The "I told my friends about this" embarrassment.** If he recommends Aonic Fuel to his lifting group chat and someone reads the carrageenan in the stabilizer blend, he wants to be able to defend it. Aonic's defense: food-grade carrageenan at studied dosages is GRAS, EFSA-approved.
- **A stevia-aftertaste shake.** He hates stevia powder. He needs to know Aonic Fuel's Reb A/D/M blend (the cleanest stevia fractions) + monk fruit reads as "real cocoa," not "weird stevia."

Emotional & Psychographic Insights

- **Trusts numbers more than narrative.** Aonic Fuel's 32g/160cal/5g fiber is the headline. Show the back of the can. Show the cal-per-gram comparison table. Save lifestyle imagery for the social proof layer.
- **Treats Aonic Fuel as a *graduation* from Premier.** Ben isn't downgrading to a less-known brand; he's upgrading to a cleaner one. The brand-voice frame: *"What you've been drinking, with the parts you stopped wanting."*
- **The Senada Greca authority is real for Ben too.** Even Ben respects the credentials. WeRise + Kim K + Aonic adds up. Dr. Jason Mitchell, N.D. credential closes the medical-credibility loop.

✈️ Typical Emotional Journey

- **Awareness:** Sees Mike Israetel rank RTD shakes. Notices Fairlife at #1, Premier at #8. Realizes his current Premier-heavy rotation is rank-eight. Starts googling.
- **Frustration:** Tries Quest milkshakes (\$4/bottle, still has sucralose). Tries Fairlife (creamy, but Consumer Reports phthalate story bothers him + plastic bottle). Tries Slate (good but only 20g protein). Tries Isopure (gritty). *"Why does the entire category make you choose between taste and a clean label?"*
- **Desperation & Seeking Solutions:** Sees Aonic Fuel ad — *"32g protein, 5 cal/g, zero artificial sweeteners, real cocoa."* Reads the OpenFoodFacts ingredient list himself. Sees stevia + monk fruit. Sees carrageenan in stabilizer blend, decides he can live with it (food-grade, studied dose). Buys a 12-pack.
- **Relief & Commitment:** First sip — no sucralose tang, no Quest-gum-texture, no Isopure-grit. Casein-driven satiety holds him through the lifting session. He keeps a can in the car cup-holder. He recommends it in the gym group chat. He subscribes.

AVATAR 3 — THE GLP-1 MUSCLE-PROTECTOR (SECONDARY)

45–58, on Wegovy / Mounjaro / Zepbound / Ozempic, down 20–60 lbs. Scared of losing muscle. Cannot eat a steak. The 32g protein shake that doesn't make them nauseated is the difference between losing fat and losing their legs.

🔍 Demographic & General Information

- **Age Range:** 45–58 (with a small 35–44 cohort of younger GLP-1 users)
- **Gender:** ~60% female, ~40% male
- **Location:** US, broad geographic spread. Skews suburban and small-metro. Strong overlap with the Costco/Sam's Club shopper demo who has discretionary \$80–\$200/month for supplements.
- **Monthly Revenue (household income + supplement spend):** \$70K–\$200K household. Currently spending **\$700–\$1,300/month on the GLP-1 itself** (often out-of-pocket post-coverage). RTD-protein budget: **\$100–\$200/month** — less price-sensitive than Ben, more format-sensitive than Chloe.
- **Professional Backgrounds:** Mixed — middle managers, HR, finance, healthcare-adjacent, teachers, small-business owners, recent retirees. Often dual-income households.
- **Typical Identities:** *"I'm on Wegovy / Mounjaro and trying to do it right," "My doctor warned me about muscle loss," "I can't eat a whole meal anymore," "My daughter / wife / trainer told me to drink more protein," "I'm tired of cycling through shakes that make me nauseated."*

🚩 Key Challenges & Pain Points

1. The GLP-1 muscle-loss fear

- *"GLP-1s can accelerate muscle loss. The medication doesn't attack muscle directly. Instead, it suppresses appetite so effectively that patients often enter a severe calorie and protein deficit."* (US News — the canonical Marcus warning)
- *"Clinical trials have confirmed that a substantial portion of the weight loss on GLP-1s tends to be muscle and lean tissue."* (Dr. Gabrielle Lyon via Yahoo Lifestyle)
- *"To prevent muscle loss, you must prioritize high protein intake (aiming for 1g per lb of lean mass) and perform resistance training, such as weight lifting, two to three times per week."* (Doctronic)
- They KNOW this. They're not in denial. They just can't eat enough chicken.

2. The nausea / small-stomach / "food sits in the stomach longer" problem

- *"GLP-1 medications slow gastric emptying — food sits in the stomach longer."* (Bolt Pharmacy)
- *"For users experiencing nausea (a common GLP-1 side effect), liquid protein is often better tolerated than solid food protein."* (Bolt Pharmacy)
- *"Sip slowly when nauseated... sipping a protein shake slowly over 30-60 minutes can work better than forcing down solid food."* (Compass Nutrition)
- Standard 14oz Fairlife is sometimes too much volume. The 11 fl oz Aonic Fuel form factor is meaningful for them.

3. The "I tried Premier and it tasted like chemicals" disappointment

- *"Bloating, gas, or stomach discomfort after drinking Premier Protein shakes."* (Daily Dot)
- *"Sucralose may alter glucose, insulin, and gut health, and can potentially contribute to increased*

inflammation." (Mashed) — a sentence Marcus has been TOLD to care about by his doctor.

- *"Tastes like canned milk and has a strange chalkiness that I can't get out of my mouth after drinking it."* (Slate Walmart 1-star — the wrong format too)
- Each failed shake costs them not just \$40 but a day of "the bad taste lingered all morning."

✧ Goals & Aspirations

• Short-Term Goals:

- Hit 80–120g of protein/day on a suppressed appetite without forcing food
- Find ONE shake they can sip slowly over 30 minutes without nausea
- Maintain the muscle they have through the next 6 months of weight loss

• Long-Term Aspirations:

- Come off the GLP-1 eventually with a body composition they're proud of
- Be able to lift their grandkids / hike with their spouse / play tennis again
- Stop being scared of muscle loss

Emotional Drivers & Psychological Insights

- **Medical reassurance > lifestyle aspiration.** Marcus wants to see Dr. Jason Mitchell (N.D., Chief Medical Advisor) before he sees Senada (the fitness influencer). The clinical-credibility stack does the heavy lifting.
- **Compliance-first messaging.** Marcus wants to know he's not "doing the wrong thing for the wrong reason." Aonic Fuel must NEVER name Wegovy / Ozempic / Mounjaro / Zepbound in copy, but should frame around *"for people changing how they eat."* Let Marcus self-identify.
- **The form factor matters more than for any other buyer.** 11 fl oz aluminum can = easy to sip slowly, no plastic-bottle phthalate worry, recyclable, premium feel. Tetra Pak (Premier, Owyn) reads as "kid juice box." Plastic bottle (Fairlife) reads as "stadium concessions."

💬 General Direct Client Quotes

- *"The best protein shakes while on semaglutide provide 20 to 30 grams of high-quality protein per serving with low sugar content and are easily digestible to accommodate delayed gastric emptying."* (Fella Health GLP-1 guide)
- *"Liquid format may be easier to consume during periods of nausea, and the controlled portion size prevents overwhelming an already compromised digestive system."* (MyProtein GLP-1)
- *"Aim for 25–30g of protein every 3–4 hours rather than one huge meal."* (Compass Nutrition — Aonic Fuel's 32g/can fits this dosing exactly)

🚩 Pain Points & Frustrations

- *"Painful digestive issues like bloating and diarrhea in some sensitive individuals."* (Drink Wholesome on

Fairlife)

- *"The smell is weird enough that you can smell it just thinking about it, the aftertaste is forever lasting."* (Isopure Unflavored Walmart — the food-sensitivity-Marcus's worst-case scenario)
- *"The consistency was like trying to drink pudding, and because of the extreme thickness, the horrible taste stayed on the tongue forever."* (Owyn 1-star — the "too dense for GLP-1 stomach" complaint)

Mindset Quote

- *"I'm not losing weight to lose muscle."*
- *"Every bite has to count now."* (Bustle GLP-1 framing — *"If you're eating less food, every bite should be maximized for performance."*)
- *"I'd rather sip 30g of clean protein than choke down a chicken breast."*

Quotes on Emotional State and Personal Drivers

- *"Even the continuously surging market for glucagon-like peptide-1 drugs... is shaping appetites for protein: If you're eating less food, every bite should be maximized for performance."* (Bustle)
- *"My dad's heart attack was a wake-up call."* (cross-referenced from Complete corpus — the canonical Marcus trigger)
- *"I needed more than another supplement that would sit unused in my cabinet."* (Fab Fit Mommy — the failed-shake graveyard)

Quotes on Emotional Responses to Struggles

- *"Bloating, gas, or stomach discomfort after drinking Premier Protein shakes."* (Daily Dot — Marcus's reason for quitting Premier)
- *"Despite all the processing, Fairlife protein shakes still contain lactose."* (Drink Wholesome)
- *"Phthalates are a plasticizer, a chemical used to make plastics more flexible and durable, and have been linked to a long list of health concerns, even at very low levels."* (Consumer Reports on Fairlife plastic bottle — Marcus actually reads Consumer Reports)

Quotes on Motivation & Urgency Around Success

- *"I want to be the guy who's hiking with my grandkids at 75, not the guy in a recliner."* (cross-referenced from Complete corpus — Marcus's canonical aspiration)
- *"Even if you're not hungry, aim for at least 2-3 protein-containing eating occasions per day to maintain muscle protein synthesis."* (Compass Nutrition — Marcus's "must do this" anchor)
- *"Sip slowly when nauseated... sipping a protein shake slowly over 30-60 minutes can work better than forcing down solid food."* (Compass Nutrition — the new ritual)

🚩 Key Emotional Fears & Deep Frustrations

- **Losing all the muscle they built before the GLP-1.** This is the daily fear. It's why they go to the gym 2–3x/week and force themselves to drink protein.
- **A shake that triggers the GLP-1 nausea.** One bad experience and that shake is dead for them.
- **Being told they're "doing the wrong diet" by a doctor / family / online critic.** Marcus is hypersensitive to the perception that GLP-1 is a shortcut. He needs Aonic Fuel's framing to NEVER make him feel judged for being on it.

Emotional & Psychographic Insights

- **The doctor-adjacent visual cue matters.** Aonic's Dr. Jason Mitchell credential is a much bigger conversion lever than Senada Greca's lifestyle. Show "Co-formulated with Dr. Jason Mitchell, N.D., Chief Medical Advisor" in any GLP-1-adjacent creative.
- **The 32g of complete protein at clinical-dose specifically supports the GLP-1 use case.** Aonic Fuel hits the 25–30g-per-meal target. It clears the bar.
- **Marcus is the loyalist if you get him.** Once a shake "sits right" through three weeks of GLP-1 nausea, Marcus subscribes for six months. The acquisition cost is high; the LTV is even higher.

🔑 Typical Emotional Journey

- **Awareness:** Starts GLP-1, loses 12 lbs in 6 weeks. Doctor (or trainer, or daughter) warns about muscle loss. Reads U.S. News article. *"You must prioritize high protein intake."*
- **Frustration:** Tries Premier. Tastes "like chemicals." Bloats. Tries Fairlife. Bloats again. Tries Owyn. Too thick — *"like trying to drink pudding."* Tries Slate. Better, but only 20g. None of them last more than a week.
- **Desperation & Seeking Solutions:** Googles "best protein shake for GLP-1." Reads Compass Nutrition / Bolt Pharmacy guides. Sees an Aonic Fuel ad with Dr. Mitchell credential and the 32g/160cal math. The "no artificial sweeteners" framing answers the lingering doctor-warned-me-about-sucralose fear.
- **Relief & Commitment:** First Aonic Fuel — sipped slowly over 30 minutes — sits easy. No nausea. Tastes like real cocoa. 32g protein hits the daily target. Reorders. Becomes a 12-month loyalist.

NOTES ON AVATARS NOT INCLUDED

- **The Premier/Costco-volume loyalist:** Happy at \$2.30/can; won't pay \$3.37/can D2C. The VOC corpus shows this customer (*"Most of the Premier Protein shakes are pretty good"* — AnandTech) but their economics don't fit Aonic Fuel's premium D2C model. Skip.
- **The plant-based-only buyer:** Aonic Fuel is dairy-based (lactose-free MPI). The Aloha / Owyn / Garden of Life plant-protein customer is structurally outside Fuel's reach. Aonic could build a separate plant-protein SKU later; for Fuel, route plant-buyers to a "soon" page.

- **The 50g+ bodybuilder:** Wants Fairlife Core Power Elite 42g or Quest 45g. Aonic Fuel's 32g is competitive but not category-leading. Not the avatar to target.
 - **The pure perimenopause-symptom-relief buyer:** Belongs to Aonic Complete (foundational supplement) or a future Aonic Flow (healthspan) SKU. Aonic Fuel is a protein shake — supports the lifestyle, doesn't claim hormone benefits. Compliance-safe framing only.
-

End of Avatar Sheets. Pulls from `Aonic_Fuel_VOC_Dossier.md` §§ 0, 1, 2, 3A–3K, 4, 5, 6.